3. Kookaburra in Australia is called ‘Laughing Jacks’.

55.

Longest rivers in each state or territory			
State/territory	*River name*	*Length*	
		km	*miles*
Australian Capital Territory	Murrumbidgee River	59	37
New South Wales	Murray River	1,808	1,123
Northern Territory	Victoria River	510	317
Queensland	Flinders River	1,004	624
South Australia	Murray River	700	435
Tasmania	South Esk River	245	152
Victoria	Yarra River	654	406
Western Australia	Gascoyne River	834	518

56. Potential effects of El Niño on Australia include:
- Reduced rainfall
- Warmer temperatures
- Shift in temperature extremes
- Increased frost risk
- Reduced tropical cyclone numbers
- Later monsoon onset
- Increased fire danger in southeast Australia
- Decreased alpine snow depths

57. **The air above Antarctica is suddenly getting warmer - here’s what it means for Australia**

1. Record warm temperatures above Antarctica over the coming weeks are likely to bring aboveaverage spring temperatures and below-average rainfall across large parts of New South Wales and southern Queensland.
2. The warming began in the last week of August, when temperatures in the stratosphere high above the South Pole began rapidly heating in a phenomenon called “sudden stratospheric warming”.
3. In the coming weeks the warming is forecast to intensify, and its effects will extend downward to Earth’s surface, affecting much of eastern Australia over the coming months.